‘South Asia Studies’, which gives them monopoly over Bharat’s subjectivity, history and therefore, its future. This is one of the reasons for my conscious decision to place Bharat-specific literature on colonial consciousness alongside global literature on decoloniality to demonstrate that while the latter is celebrated in the context of the Americas, the former is relentlessly maligned despite seeking to achieve a similar goal as decoloniality—to stand up for Indic indigenous consciousness which is surrounded by an ocean of proselytising and expansionist colonialities. Clearly, even if postcolonial and Marxist schools have advanced the cause of indigeneities outside Bharat, the principle of harm suggests that both schools have harmed Bharat’s indigenous consciousness more than empowering it.

It is for the above-mentioned reasons that the decolonial school merits serious consideration.[14] The decolonial option gives the indigenous consciousness a voice it sorely needs to speak out against both forms of continuing colonialities.[15] Decoloniality, to my mind, serves as a better lens because it clips the universalising tendency of both by awakening people to the presence of such colonialities and enables movement towards their own cultural experience. Whether this movement towards indigenous consciousness ultimately translates to retention of colonial consciousness or embracing of indigeneity or formulation of a decolonial yet hybrid framework that is different from the hybridity celebrated by postcolonial thought, remains a matter of analysis by domain experts. After all, such choices are significantly contingent on the ‘practicality’ and ‘pragmatism’ of replacement of colonial consciousness with indigenous consciousness.

From the perspective of ascertaining a ‘cut-off’ period to determine Bharat’s indigeneity by expanding Bharat’s version of colonialities to include both forms, one may tentatively arrive at the eighth century when the first wave of recorded Muslim Arab invasions of Bharat began. This is similar to European colonialism being traced by the decolonial school to the fifteenth century when the Age of Discovery began. While the period between the twelfth and sixteenth centuries is typically associated with a more consistent and frequent wave of Islamic invasions of Bharat, the eighth century certainly marked its beginning. Perhaps scholars trained in history may disagree with me with regard to the exact time period, but the underlying principle I seek to advance is similar to the position of decolonial scholars with respect to indigeneity in the context of Latin